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A STALEMATE over extending healthcare credits led to a shutdown, when Democrats denied Republicans — led by House Speaker Mike Johnson, top center — the votes needed to continue funding the government.

BIG HOLES SEEN IN WILDFIRE REPORT

Inquiry into failures falls short, supervisors say, even as they push to enact reforms.

BY REBECCA ELLIS AND TERRY CASTLEMAN

Los Angeles County supervisors criticized the long-awaited \$1.9-million outside investigation on government failures during the January wildfires as full of gaping holes after outcry from residents who say the report failed to answer their key question: Why did evacuation alerts come so late for so many?

“I’ve heard from many residents, some of whom are in the audience, who share that this report leads to more questions than answers, and, quite frankly, a lot of anger,” said Supervisor Kathryn Barger, who represents unincorporated Altadena, as the board discussed the report’s findings at its Tuesday meeting.

Nineteen people died in the Eaton fire, all but one of whom was found in west Altadena, an area that did not get evacuation alerts until hours after the fire threatened the area.

[See **Fires**, A11]

‘War-ravaged’ Portland protests troop moves

Oregonians maintain they don’t need Trump to send the Guard

BY JESSICA GARRISON



JENNY KANE Associated Press

A PROTESTER waves to Homeland Security officers at an ICE facility in Portland this week.

PORTLAND, Ore. — There is a rhetorical battle raging here in this heavily Democratic city, known for its delicious coffee, plethora of fancy restaurants, bespoke doughnuts and also for its small faction of black-clad activists.

It started Saturday when President Trump suddenly announced that he was sending the National Guard to “war-ravaged” Portland — where a small group of demonstrators have been staging a months-long protest at an Immigration and Customs Enforcement building south of downtown.

Oregon officials have pushed back forcefully, flooding their own social media with images of colorful

[See **Portland**, A7]

A dustup over Malibu fire recovery

Amid anger over slow progress, city’s rebuild ‘ambassador’ quits and says mayor should too.

BY JAMES RAINEY

The slow pace of reconstruction after January’s fire disaster has touched off a political tempest in Malibu, prompting the resignation of the city’s volunteer re-

building “ambassador” and his suggestion — along with some other rebuilding activists — that Mayor Marianne Riggins “consider gracefully stepping down.”

The controversy brings to a boil a conflict that has been simmering for months over what Malibu residents say are overly onerous rebuilding requirements. Some 720 structures in the city burned down in January, but just 69 have received initial plan approval and

only two have obtained building permits, allowing them to begin construction.

That painfully slow progress provided the backdrop Monday, as rebuilding ambassador Abe Roy told the City Council he was resigning. “Our work is far from done,” Roy told the City Council. “Two permits issued in nearly 10 months is an abomination by any standard.”

Despite all the city’s apparent privilege, the truth is

Democrats take a political risk with shutdown

To protect healthcare for millions, leaders say, the halt is a worthwhile gamble.

BY MICHAEL WILNER, ANA CEBALLOS AND ANDREA CASTILLO

WASHINGTON — Democratic lawmakers took a significant risk this week by choosing to fight the Trump administration over the extension of healthcare credits.

A stalemate over the matter led to the federal shutdown on Tuesday night, when Democrats denied Republicans the votes needed to continue funding the government, forcing hundreds of thousands of federal workers into furloughs or to work without pay.

It’s a gamble for a party facing its lowest approval numbers since the Reagan era — and a calculated risk Democratic leaders felt compelled to take.

“I am proud to be fighting to preserve healthcare for millions of people,” Sen. Adam Schiff of California said in an interview Wednesday. “I think this is a very necessary fight.”

The healthcare tax credits are set to expire at the end of the year, and if Democrats are unsuccessful in securing an extension as part of a shutdown deal, then premiums for millions of Americans are expected to skyrocket, Schiff said.

“There’s really not much that can be done to mitigate these dramatic health premium increases people are going to see unless the president and Republicans are willing to work with us on it,” he said.

Entering the shutdown, polls indicated the country was split over who would be to blame, with 19% of Americans faulting Democrats and 26% charging Republicans, according to a New York Times poll. A plurality of respondents — 33% — said both parties were responsible.

Sen. Chuck Schumer of New York, a Democrat and the Senate minority leader, is leading the charge with his worst favorability numbers among his home state residents in over 20 years — and with the highest disapproval ratings of any congressional leader, according to a recent Pew survey.

Schumer faced widespread ridicule from within his party in March after reversing course during the last government funding deadline, choosing then to

[See **Democrats**, A6]

Here’s what services will be affected

BY KAREN GARCIA, HAYLEY SMITH AND JACK DOLAN

The federal government shutdown reverberated across California on Wednesday, with resulting disruptions expected to worsen the longer the stalemate lasts.

Major transportation hubs, schools, and financial and medical services were not initially affected. Employees such as air traffic controllers and airport security officials stayed on the job. And many iconic parks continue to welcome visitors.

But some federal employees who did report for duty will not be paid until lawmakers reach an agreement and the shutdown ends.

In a host of federal agencies, the majority of employees are on furlough, with the Agriculture, Commerce and Education departments hit especially hard. Roughly 750,000 federal employees could be furloughed each day at a compensation cost of \$400 million, according to the Congressional Budget Office.

Here is how your services could be affected:

Airports and transit

Major California airports are not expected to see immediate interruptions in service.

That’s because air traffic controllers and the Transportation Security Administration will still be on the job.

[See **Services**, A6]

JANE GOODALL, 1934 – 2025

Insights into chimps — and humans



HUGO VAN LAWICK National Geographic Creative

PIONEERING PRIMATOLOGIST

Jane Goodall and baby chimpanzee Flint reach out to each other. Flint was the first infant born in Gombe, Tanzania, after Goodall’s arrival.

BY ELAINE WOO

Jane Goodall, the trailblazing naturalist whose intimate observations of chimpanzees in the African wild produced powerful insights that transformed basic conceptions of humankind, has died. She was 91.

A tireless advocate of preserving chimpanzees’ natural habitat, Goodall died on Wednesday morning in California of natural causes, the Jane Goodall Institute announced on its Instagram page.

“Dr. Goodall’s discoveries as an ethologist revolutionized science,” the institute said in a statement.

A protégé of anthropologist Louis S.B. Leakey, Goodall made history in 1960 when she discovered that chimpanzees, humankind’s closest living ancestors, made and used tools, characteristics that scientists had long thought were exclusive to humans.

[See **Goodall**, A14]

Pope talks about defining ‘pro-life’

Leo XIV challenges U.S. Catholics who are against abortion but support the death penalty. **PERSPECTIVES**, A2

Will end of perk worsen traffic?

Clean Air Vehicle Decals are now invalid and solo drivers are no longer allowed to use the car-pool lane. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

Jane Fonda keeps up political stand

The actor talks about using her celebrity to combat climate change and “existential crises.” **ENTERTAINMENT**, E1

Weather
Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 80/65. **B6**

Markets **A11**



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ROBERT GAUTHIER L.A. Times

MOOKIE Betts and the Dodgers aim to advance.

DODGERS IN NL WILD CARD

For Game 2 coverage of the Dodgers-Reds playoff series, visit latimes.com/dodgers or latimes.com/enewspaper.



‘Stagflation-lite’ economy forecast

UCLA predicts growth will slow next quarter as costs of Trump administration’s tariffs fully take hold. **BUSINESS**, A9

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